

1968 No. 2

A MEASURE passed by the National Assembly of the Church of England to make further provision for amending the Book of Common Prayer and certain enactments relating to that Book and to the burial service.
[18th December 1968]

1.—(1) At the end of the Rubric or Order in the Book of Common Prayer headed "The Order for Morning and Evening Prayer" there shall be added the following paragraph:—

"Readers and such other lay persons as may be authorised by the Bishop of the diocese may, at the invitation of the Minister of the parish or, where the Cure is vacant, or the Minister is incapacitated, at the invitation of the Churchwardens, say or sing Morning or Evening Prayer (save for the Absolution); and in case of need, where no clerk in Holy Orders or Reader or lay person authorised as aforesaid is available, the Minister or (failing him) the Churchwardens shall arrange for some suitable lay person to say or sing Morning or Evening Prayer (save for the Absolution)."

Authorisation of lay persons to officiate at Morning or Evening Prayer and to read lessons.

ss 1-4 Ref. (SAVING) (PROSP.) 1974. G.S.M. No. 3, s. 6, SCH. 2, SCH. 3.

(2) In the Order for Morning Prayer and the Order for Evening Prayer in the Book of Common Prayer the following rubric shall be inserted immediately after the Absolution:—

"If no priest be present the person saying the Service shall read the Collect for the Twenty-First Sunday after Trinity, that person and the people still kneeling."

(3) The functions of the Bishop under the paragraph added by subsection (1) hereof may be performed by a person appointed by him for the purpose, being a suffragan or assistant bishop or archdeacon of the diocese.

(4) The saying or singing of Morning or Evening Prayer in accordance with the said paragraph shall, for the purposes of section 1 of the Act of Uniformity 1662 (which requires Ministers and curates to read Morning and Evening Prayers in all churches), be deemed to be a reading by the Minister of the parish.

(5) Nothing in the Book of Common Prayer shall be taken as preventing the reading of any lesson by a lay person.

1662 c. 4.

Administra-
tion of
Sacrament
and reading of
Epistle by
authorised lay
persons.
1662 c. 4

2.—(1) Notwithstanding section 10 of the Act of Uniformity 1662 and the directions contained in the Book of Common Prayer relating to the Administration of the Lord's Supper or Holy Communion, a lay person specially authorised by the Bishop under regulations made by the Convocation of the Province with the concurrence of the Church Assembly may distribute the Holy Sacrament of the Lord's Supper to the people.

The functions of the Bishop under this subsection may be performed by a person appointed by him for the purpose, being a suffragan or assistant bishop or archdeacon of the diocese. [a]

(2) Notwithstanding any such direction as aforesaid but subject to the general directions of the Bishop, the Epistle and the Gospel may at the invitation of the Minister be read by a lay person at the celebration of the Holy Communion.

Amendments
of Baptism
Rubrics.

3.—(1) For the Introductory Rubric to the Ministration of Public Baptism of Infants contained in the Book of Common Prayer the following rubric shall be substituted :—

“Due notice, normally of at least a week, shall be given before a child is brought to the church to be baptized.

For every child to be baptized there shall be not fewer than three godparents, of whom at least two shall be of the same sex as the child and of whom at least one shall be of the opposite sex ; save that, when three cannot conveniently be had, one godfather and one godmother shall suffice. Parents may be godparents for their own children provided that the child shall have at least one other godparent. The godparents shall be persons who have been baptized and confirmed and will faithfully fulfil their responsibilities both by their care for the child committed to their charge and by the example of their own godly living. Nevertheless the Minister shall have power to dispense with the requirement of confirmation in any case in which in his judgment need so requires.

The Minister shall instruct the parents or guardians of an infant to be admitted to Holy Baptism that the same responsibilities rest on them as are in the service of Holy Baptism required of the godparents.

No Minister shall refuse or, save for the purpose of preparing or instructing the parents or guardians or godparents, delay to baptize any infant within his cure that is brought to the church to be baptized, provided that due notice has been given and the provisions relating to godparents are observed. If the Minister shall refuse or unduly delay to baptize any such infant, the parents or guardians may apply to the Bishop of the diocese who shall, after consultation with the Minister, give such directions as he thinks fit.

[a] S. 2(1) am. — 1969 C.A.M. No. 2 S. 3(5)

The Minister, before proceeding to the Baptism, shall have satisfied himself that the child presented to him has not already been baptised.

At the time appointed the godfathers and godmothers and the parents or guardians with the child must be ready at the Font, and the Priest coming to the Font (which is then to be filled with pure Water), and standing there, shall proceed as follows."

(2) The first paragraph of the Introductory Rubric to the Ministration of Private Baptism of Children (which provides for admonishing the people not to defer the baptism of their children longer than the first or second Sunday after their birth) shall be omitted; and at the beginning of the second paragraph thereof for the words "And also they shall warn them" there shall be substituted the words "The Minister of every parish shall warn the people", and the word "like" shall be omitted.

(3) For the Introductory Rubric for the Ministration of Baptism to Such as are of Riper Years there shall be substituted the following rubric:—

"When any such person as is of riper years and able to answer for himself is to be baptized, the Minister shall instruct such person, or cause him to be instructed, in the principles of the Christian religion, and exhort him so to prepare himself with prayers and fasting that he may receive this Holy Sacrament with repentance and faith.

At least a week before any such baptism is to take place, the Minister shall give notice thereof to the Bishop of the Diocese or whomsoever he shall appoint for the purpose.

The person to be baptized shall choose three, or at least two, to be his sponsors, who shall be ready to present him at the Font and afterwards put him in mind of his Christian profession and duties. No person shall be admitted to be a sponsor who has not been baptized and confirmed. Nevertheless the Minister shall have power to dispense with the requirement of confirmation in any case in which in his judgment need so requires.

At the time appointed, the sponsors shall be ready to present the person to be baptized at the Font, and standing there the Priest shall ask whether the person presented be baptized or no, and if he shall answer, No, then shall the Priest say thus".

[a] 4.—(1) The Convocations of Canterbury and York may authorise with the concurrence of the House of Laity a Table of Rules for regulating the Service when two Holy Days fall upon the same day or their Proper Services otherwise fall together, or when Services are required for Sundays after Trinity, and any

Authorisation of Tables and Rules regulating the service in certain cases.

[a] S. 4 am — 1969.C.A.M. No.2.S.3(S)

Table and Rules so authorised shall be included in the Book of Common Prayer immediately after "A Table of the Vigils, Fasts and Days of Abstinence, to be observed in the year", and shall have effect notwithstanding anything in any other Table or Rules in the said Book.

(2) Where a Table and Rules are included in the Book of Common Prayer under this section, the Convocations of Canterbury and York may authorise with the concurrence of the House of Laity amendments of the said Table and Rules or the substitution therefor of a new Table and Rules for regulating the matters aforesaid, and the amendments or substitution so authorised shall be made in the Book of Common Prayer.

(3) In this section the expression "Holy Day" means the Days set out in "A Table of all the Feasts" in the Book of Common Prayer and such other Days as the said Convocations consider should be included in any Table and Rules authorised under this section.

Amendment
of burial
service used in
certain cases.
1880 c. 41.

5. Section 13 of the Burial Laws Amendment Act 1880 (which authorises the use of a burial service prescribed or approved of by the Ordinary in cases where the Office for the burial of the dead in the Book of Common Prayer may not be used, and in other cases at the request of the person responsible for the burial of the deceased) shall have effect as if the reference to the said Office included a reference to any form of service available for the burial of suicides and approved under the Prayer Book (Alternative and Other Services) Measure 1965) and as if the words "consisting of prayers taken from the Book of Common Prayer and portions of Holy Scriptures" were omitted:

[Provided that a burial service so prescribed or approved shall be neither contrary to, nor indicative of any departure from, the doctrines of the Church of England]

1965 No. 1.
[] Ref. (SAVING)
(PROSP) - 1974.
C.S.M. - No. 3,
S. 6, SECT. 1-3.

Extent.

6. This Measure shall extend to the whole of the Provinces of Canterbury and York except the Channel Islands:

Provided that this Measure may be applied to the Channel Islands as defined in the Channel Islands (Church Legislation) Measures 1931 and 1957 or either of them in accordance with those Measures.

Short Title.

7. This Measure may be cited as the Prayer Book (Further Provisions) Measure 1968.

Annex 472. 1968. Pt. II. p. 2532. s. 5.
^{1/} authorised by Canon of the General Synod or approved thereunder
(*Subst. (prosp.) by 1974. G.S.M. No. 3, s. 6, sch. 1 para. 2.*)